

NEST Cluster Tech Conclave OCTAVATE

10 - 12, August 2026

Organized by

North Eastern Science & Technology Cluster
for Promoting Research, Innovation & Skill Development



MINISTRY OF DEVELOPMENT OF
NORTH EASTERN REGION

North Eastern Council
Government of India



VENUE:

Indian Institute of Technology Guwahati
Assam-781039, India

OCTAVATE 2026

NEST CLUSTER TECH CONCLAVE

INNOVATE • COLLABORATE • ACCELERATE

Building the Future from the North East



AUGUST 10-12, 2026

10th - 12th August, 2026



IIT GUWAHATI

Guwahati, Assam, India



GRASSROOT TECHNOLOGIES & INNOVATIONS

Empowering communities.
Transforming lives.



SEMICONDUCTOR & ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

Smart technologies.
Intelligent tomorrow.



BAMBOO INNOVATION, TECHNOLOGIES & SKILL DEVELOPMENT

Sustainable. Strong.
Scalable.



BIODEGRADABLE PLASTICS & SOLID WASTE MANAGEMENT

Circular solutions.
Cleaner tomorrow.

PROGRAMME HIGHLIGHTS



INSPIRING KEYNOTES

Hear from world-renowned scientists, policymakers, industry leaders, entrepreneurs and global experts shaping the future of technology, innovation and development.



INNOVATION & TECHNOLOGY EXPO

Explore cutting-edge technologies, startups, prototypes and research demonstrations from leading institutions and industries.



NATIONAL HACKATHON & INNOVATION CHALLENGE

Solve real-world problems, showcase your ideas and win exciting prizes with mentorship from leading experts and industry mentors.



STUDENT INNOVATION SHOWCASE

Present your research, posters, prototypes and innovative ideas in front of eminent academicians, scientists and industry professionals.



GLOBAL EXPERT SESSIONS

Engage with internationally acclaimed researchers and technology leaders through keynote lectures, panel discussions and interactive technical sessions.



INDUSTRY-ACADEMIA-GOVERNMENT CONNECT

Network and build strategic collaborations with policymakers, industries, startups, funding agencies, incubators and research organizations.



STARTUP & ENTREPRENEURSHIP ARENA

Pitch ideas, connect with mentors and investors, and explore incubation, funding, commercialization and technology transfer opportunities through the NEST ecosystem.



POLICY DIALOGUE FORUM

Participate in discussions on emerging technologies, innovation policies, funding opportunities and the future roadmap for North East India's innovation ecosystem.



FOUR FUTURE-FOCUSED TECHNOLOGY TRACKS

Deep dive into breakthrough research and innovations across four key thematic tracks driving sustainable and inclusive development.



AWARDS, RECOGNITION & NETWORKING

Win prestigious awards for hackathons, research presentations and innovations while networking with 200+ delegates from academia, government, industry, startups and research organizations.



EXPERIENCE THE SPIRIT OF NORTH EAST INDIA

Celebrate the rich cultural heritage, vibrant traditions and warm hospitality through cultural performances and immersive networking experiences.

GREAT OPPORTUNITY!
Win Prizes Worth
₹9 LAKHS!
TOTAL PRIZE POOL
₹9,00,000



Compete in Hackathons,
Poster Presentations, Startup Challenges
and Innovation Competitions.

WHO SHOULD ATTEND?

SCHOOL STUDENTS



- Innovation challenges & hackathons
- Hands-on exposure to emerging technologies
- Interaction with scientists & innovators
- Career inspiration in STEM

COLLEGE & UNIVERSITY STUDENTS



- Present research & prototypes
- Network with experts & recruiters
- Explore internships, incubation & startup opportunities
- Learn from leading researchers & entrepreneurs

POLICYMAKERS & GOVERNMENT OFFICIALS



- Engage in policy dialogues
- Discover scalable technologies for regional development
- Build partnerships with academia & industry
- Shape the innovation roadmap for North East India

GLOBAL EXPERTS & RESEARCHERS



- Showcase research & best practices
- Build international collaborations
- Engage with India's growing innovation ecosystem
- Identify joint research & technology transfer opportunities

STARTUPS, INDUSTRY & ENTREPRENEURS



- Pitch ideas & products
- Connect with mentors & investors
- Explore funding, incubation & market access
- Scale innovations & build impact

200+ DELEGATES

3 DAYS

4 THEMATIC TRACKS

EXPO & DEMO ZONE

STARTUP PITCHES

HACKATHON & COMPETITIONS

GLOBAL NETWORKING

IDEAS CONVERGE • TECHNOLOGIES EMERGE • PARTNERSHIPS FLOURISH

Be part of North East India's biggest innovation & technology conclave!

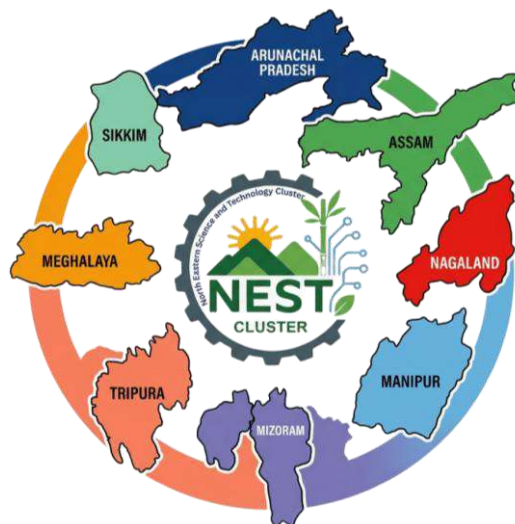
Contact : NEST Cluster Octavate Secretariat | Tel : +91 - 361 - 2914069 | <https://www.iitg.ac.in/nest>



NEST Cluster: Concept Note

North Eastern Science & Technology [NEST] Cluster of IIT Guwahati is a Section 8 Company at IIT Guwahati, funded by the Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region [MDoNER] through the North Eastern Council [NEC], and is building a technology-driven innovation ecosystem across North East India. Its efforts rest on four interlinked pillars that carry ideas from the region's grassroots to the global stage:

- **Network & outreach:**
Connects spoke institutes, universities, and R&D centres across every North East state of India into one collaborative network.
- **Technology development & dissemination:**
Turns research into field-ready technologies and gets them into the hands of industry and communities.
- **Human Resource Development:**
Builds capability locally first, then connects talent to national and global opportunities - Local to Global.
- **Entrepreneurship:**
Incubates start-ups and links innovators with mentors, industry, and funding.



NEST Cluster also brings these pillars to life through a continuous calendar of capacity-building initiatives: Skill Development Programmes (STPs), Entrepreneurship Development Programmes (EDPs), Hackathons, Conferences, Symposiums, Internship Programmes, and Certification Courses. Together, these initiatives turn ideas into impact across the North Eastern Region of India.



The Cluster actively empowers women and youth through entrepreneurship, skill development and innovation-led livelihood generation. Working closely with Farmer-Producer Organizations (FPOs), Self-Help Groups (SHGs), cooperative societies, artisan groups and community clusters, NEST strengthens local value chains by providing access to technology, capacity building, incubation support and market linkages, thereby fostering an inclusive and resilient innovation ecosystem across North East India.

A Concept Note

NEST Cluster – OCTAVATE 2026

OCTAVATE is the premier annual tech conclave organized by the North Eastern Science and Technology [NEST] Cluster of IIT Guwahati, to be held from 10th to 12th August 2026 at the Indian Institute of Technology Guwahati. The focus on OCTAVATE stems from the need to connect the North East's fragmented pockets of grassroots innovation, bamboo and biodegradable technologies, AI, and semiconductor, research into a single, coordinated ecosystem — advancing NEST Cluster's four pillars of networking spoke institutes across every North East state of India, translating research into field-ready technology, incubating start-ups, and building local talent, thereby carrying the region from "Local to Global". The OCTAVATE bridges between the government, academia, industry, research, policy, and communities — turning the North East into a technology contributor, not just a beneficiary, while boosting livelihoods and global visibility.

Over the three days of conclave, **Day 1** opens with the inauguration, keynote addresses, and MoU exchanges with partner institutions. **Day 2** features a Product Expo alongside technical sessions and hackathons across four verticals, and **Day 3** hosts entrepreneurship and policy–roadmap sessions, closing with the valedictory ceremony and awards. In essence, OCTAVATE 2026 is where the North East's grassroots ingenuity meets global ambition — a launch pad turning regional promise into a resilient, innovation-driven future.



A Concept Note

Mission of OCTAVATE 2026:

- **Showcase innovation:** Spotlights regional research, breakthrough tech, and emerging start-ups through an immersive live Product Expo.
- **Accelerate technology:** Advances ideas through technical talks and hackathons across four verticals.
- **Launchpad for founders:** Champions young innovators from pitch to prototype through Start-up to Scale-Up sessions and elite NEST Cluster mentorship.
- **Bridge for young researchers:** Aligns academic talent with start-up mentors through the READY initiative, transforming raw research into viable market innovations.
- **Voice in policy:** Unites government, academia, and industry to shape a regional technology roadmap.
- **Local roots, global reach:** Anchors breakthroughs in North Eastern culture while driving NEST Cluster's Local to Global mandate.



A Concept Note

Relevant research areas of societal relevance that will be focused on during OCTAVATE 2026:

- Grassroots technologies and Frugal Innovations for rural and community development.
- Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning and Intelligent Systems for societal and industrial applications.
- Semiconductor devices, sensors, Embedded Systems and Electronics Technologies.
- Bamboo Science, Engineered Bamboo and Sustainable Bamboo Products.
- Biodegradable Plastics, Biopolymers and Sustainable materials.

- Solid Waste Management, Circular Economy and Waste-to-Value Technologies.
- Agricultural Technologies, Precision Farming and Smart Rural Solutions.
- Indigenous Knowledge Systems and Traditional Technology Innovations.
- Renewable Energy, Climate Resilience and Green Technologies.
- IoT, Robotics, Drones and Smart Connected Systems.
- Food Processing, Value addition and Bio-based Product Development.
- Technology Translation, Commercialization and Intellectual Property Management.
- Startup Innovation, Entrepreneurship and Technology Incubation.
- Skill Development, Livelihood Generation and Capacity Building.
- Policy, Industry-Academia Collaboration and Innovation Ecosystem Development.

Target Participants:

- Ministries/Departments of the Govt. of India & the North East State Govt.
- Industries, PSUs, Start-ups & Private sector companies
- Laboratories & Technical Institutes of North East
- Research Councils/ Organizations
- Educational Institutes and Colleges of North East (Universities/Institutes of Assam, Arunachal, Tripura, Mizoram, Sikkim, Nagaland, Meghalaya, Manipur and other central organizations of Research/Higher Education).



Registration Type	Fee
College/ University Students	₹1,000/-
Spot Registration	₹1,500/-
Start-ups / Researchers	₹3,000/-
Academia/ Govt. Employees	₹5,000/-
READY Scheme	₹8,000/-
Hackathon Entry School Students	₹500/- (per team of 2)
Others	₹2,500/- (per team of 3)
Unlimited Competition Pass for all schemes	₹10,000/-

Last Date to Apply: 03rd August 2026 | web: <https://iitg.ac.in/nest/home>

A Concept Note

Day 1 - Registration & Inaugural Day: 10th Aug. 2026

Time	Activity	Details
11:00 - 14:00	Registration & Welcome Desk	Delegate registration, badge collection, and info desk
14:00 - 15:00	Lunch	Lunch for early arrivals, speakers, and delegates
15:00 - 15:25	Expo Inaugural Ceremony	Ribbon-cutting and formal opening of the Product Expo by the Chief Guest and dignitaries
15:30 - 16:00	Inaugural Ceremony - Opening & Lamp Lighting	Opening remarks, lamp lighting, introduction to North Eastern Science & Technology Cluster
16:00 - 17:00	Keynote & Special Addresses	Keynote by chief guest; addresses by invited dignitaries and institutional leaders.
17:00 - 17:15	MoUs Exchange	MoUs exchange between the HUB and Spokes Institutes and the opening of the NEST Cluster Spokes
17:15 - 18:00	Panel Discussion	Panel on "Science, Technology and Innovation in North East India" (Govt., academia, industry, MSMEs, start-ups, and aligned agencies)
18:00 - 18:30	Vote of Thanks & Day-2 Briefing	Formal closing of inaugural session; announcements for the next day
18:30 - 19:30	Cultural Programme (North Eastern States)	Performances representing different states of the North East.
19:30 onwards	Gala / Networking Dinner	Informal interactions among speakers, government officers, faculty, and participants

Day 2 - Product Expo, Technologies & Hackathon Session: 11th Aug. 2026

Time	Activity			
09:30 – 11:00	NEST Cluster Annual Meeting [Close Room]			
10:00 – 16:30	Product Expo by HUB, Spoke Institutes and Start-ups			
10:00 – 13:00	Session 1 – Technologies Sessions			
Parallel Session				
Technical Talks on Vertical 1 (Grassroot Technologies) (HALL 1)	Technical Talks on Vertical 2 (Semiconductor and AI) (HALL 2)	Technical Talks on Vertical 3 (Bamboo Technologies) (HALL 3)	Technical Talks on Vertical 4 (Biodegradable Plastics and Waste Management) (HALL 4)	
13:00 – 14:15	Lunch Break	Buffet lunch; suggested seating mix of policy makers, faculty, and participants to encourage interaction.		
14:30 – 16:30	Session 2 – Hackathon Sessions			
Hackathon on Vertical 1 (HALL 1)	Hackathon on Vertical 2 (HALL 2)	Hackathon on Vertical 3 (HALL 3)	Hackathon on Vertical 4 (HALL 4)	

16:30 - 17:00	Poster Presentation (Tentative), Tea Break & Networking	- Poster presentation by the Participants on each vertical (Tentative) - Tea/coffee; targeted networking between government officers, faculty, industry, and start-ups
17:00 - 17:30	Session 3 - Thematic Dialogue / Open House	Moderated discussion, feedback from stakeholders, and identification of collaboration opportunities for the Cluster.
17:30 - 18:30	Cultural Programme (North Eastern States)	Performances representing different states of the North East.
19:30 onwards	Informal Dinner / City Time	Informal interactions among speakers, government officers, faculty, and participants during dinner time.

Day 3 - Product Expo, Startup, Policy Making, READY & Closing Ceremony:
12th Aug. 2026

Time	Activity			
10:00 - 16:00	Product Expo by HUB, Spoke Institutes and Start-ups			
10:00 - 13:00	Session 4: Start-up to Scale -Up: Interactive Entrepreneurship Session			
Time	Activity	Description	Engagement element	Outcome
0 - 20 min	Icebreaker and Start-up Bingo	Participants interact through a fun networking bingo based on startups, innovation, sustainability, funding and entrepreneurship	Movement-based networking game	Participants become comfortable and actively engaged
20 - 50 min	60-second Start-up Idea Challenge	Teams or individuals pitch a start-up idea in just 60 seconds based on NEST Cluster Verticals themes	Fast pitching and creativity challenge	Confidence-building and idea generation
50 - 100 min	Build a Start-up Activity	Teams develop a mini-startup model, including a product idea, target customer, branding, revenue model, and marketing strategies.	Team collaboration and hands-on planning	Practical understanding of start-up creation
100 - 120 min	Connect with NEST Cluster: From Idea to Scaleup	Interactive discussion on how NEST Cluster can support startups through incubation, mentoring, prototyping, technical guidance, networking, funding opportunities, industry linkages, product validation, branding and technology commercialisation. Participants can also present how NEST can scale their ideas.	Open interaction, mentor guidance, ecosystem mapping	Awareness about NEST ecosystem, startup support opportunities and long-term collaboration pathways

Programme

Parallel Session on Policy Roadmap				
10:30 – 13:00	Session 4: Policy and Future Map		Thematic talks by government officers on schemes, funding opportunities, and regional policies; includes a short comfort/stretch break around mid-session if needed.	
Policies and Future Roadmap decision on Vertical 1 (HALL 1)		Policies and Future Roadmap decision on Vertical 2 (HALL 2)	Policies and Future Roadmap decision on Vertical 3 (HALL 3)	Policies and Future Roadmap decision on Vertical 4 (HALL 4)
13:00 – 14:15	Lunch Break	Delegates are encouraged to visit the exhibition area before/after lunch.		
14:30 – 16:30	Parallel Session on NEST Cluster READY			
14:30 – 16:30	Parallel Session: READY (Research Assistance for Dynamic Youth)		Young researchers and students engage directly with start-up founders and mentors to receive feedback on research ideas and learn pathways from research to innovation.	
14:30 – 16:30	OCTAVATE Connect: North East India and South East Asia Dialogue		Talks and representatives from different South Asian countries	
16:30 – 16:45	High Tea		Tea/coffee and light snacks; final networking opportunity	
17:00 onwards	Closing Ceremony & Prize Distribution		Brief report of the conference, feedback remarks, announcement of best poster/expo awards, closing remarks, and formal vote of thanks.	

Chief Patron



Prof. Devendra Jaliha
Chairman, NEST Cluster
Director, IIT Guwahati

Conference Chair



Prof. Vimal Katiyar
Project Director & Faculty-Incharge,
NEST Cluster
Professor, IIT Guwahati

Co - Chairs



Prof. Amit Kumar
Professor, IIT Guwahati



Prof. Poonam Kumari
Professor, IIT Guwahati

Organizing Secretary



Dr. Kiran Kumar Gali
Chief Executive Officer (CEO)
NEST Cluster of IIT Guwahati

Venue :



Indian Institute of Technology Guwahati,
Guwahati, Assam - 781039, India

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Chief Patron

Prof. Devendra Jaliha
Chairman, NEST Cluster
Director, IIT Guwahati

Conference Chair

Prof. Vimal Katiyar
Director & Faculty-Incharge,
NEST Cluster
Professor, IIT Guwahati

Co - Chairs

Prof. Amit Kumar
Professor, IIT Guwahati

Prof. Poonam Kumari
Professor, IIT Guwahati

Organizing Secretary

Dr. Kiran Kumar Gali
Chief Executive Officer (CEO)
NEST Cluster

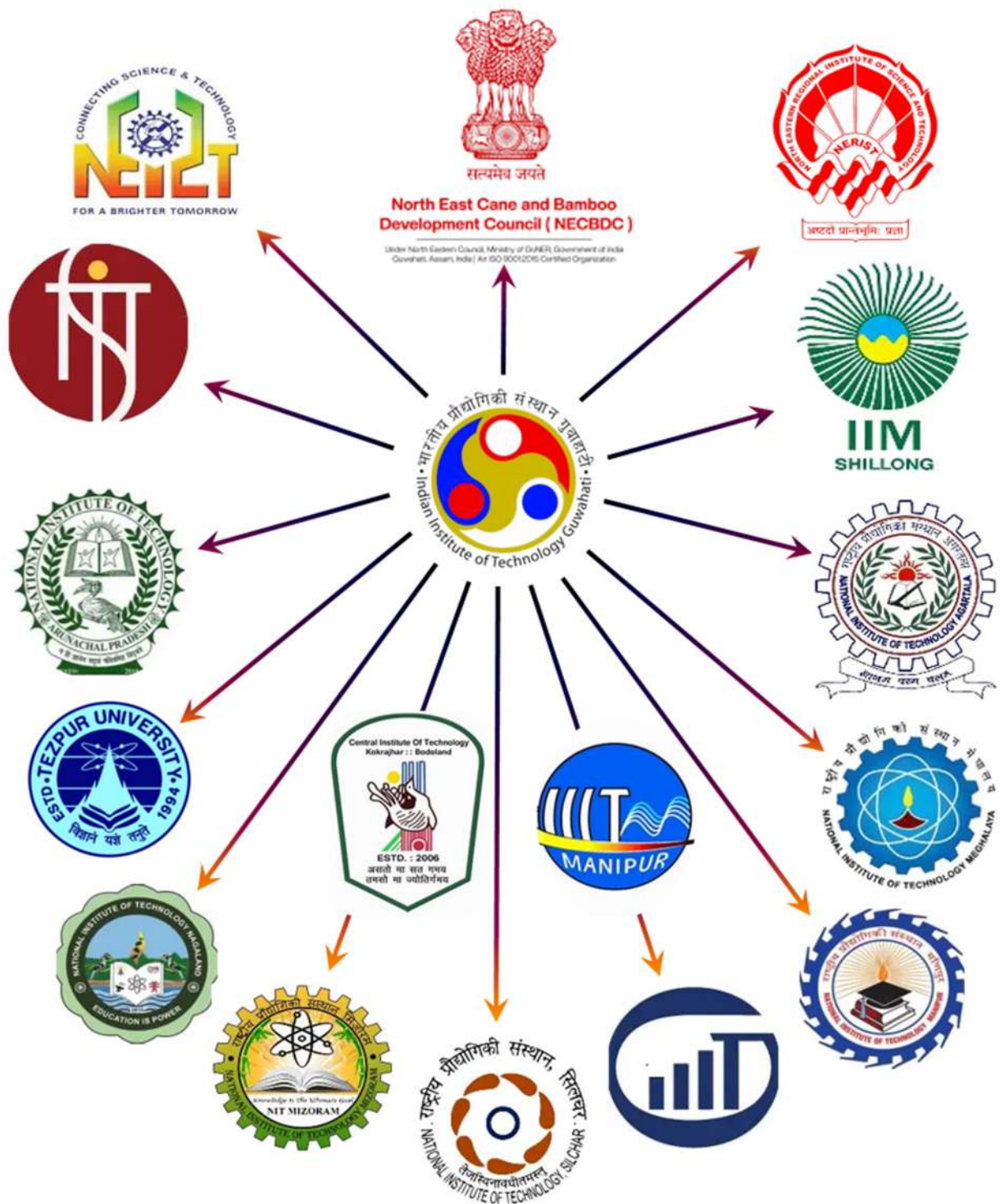
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North Eastern Science and Technology Cluster HUB and Spokes



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NEST Cluster Local to Global Reach



NEST Cluster Local-Global Associates



NEST Cluster Startups

